

nect segments at a sharp corner.

The more anchor points a path has, the more control you are going to have over its shape, but too much of a good thing can be bad—many unnecessary anchor points are going to make the path difficult to edit.

Enough talk; let's begin creating our paths.

The Pen Tool

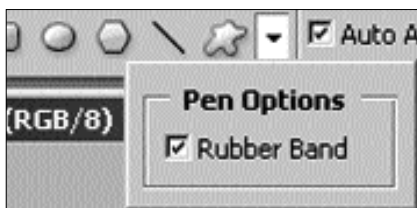
You can draw paths one anchor point at a time using the Pen tool , or use the Freeform Pen tool  to draw the path freehand.

When you select either of these tools, use the option bar to select whether you want to create a shape layer (a new layer will be created and the path will fill with colour as you draw it) or create an empty path.



The Path Options

If you'd like to see a preview of the path as you draw it, click on the inverted arrow on the option bar and select Rubber Band. We recommend using this option, especially if you're new to vectors and paths.



Turn on the Rubber Band to see the path as it is being made

Drawing The Path

To draw a path with the Pen tool, click to create an anchor point, and drag the mouse to set the direction for the path. To create a closed path (one without a beginning or an end), work your way back to the first anchor point; you will notice a small “O” appear next to the cursor—this means that the path will be closed when you click.